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coverage amount of Rs 2.58 lakh crore. During the current Financial Year (from April to August), 3.34 lakh proposals have been approved amounting to Rs 20,278 crore. Over a period of last few years, there has been a gradual increase in the guarantees issued to the NBFCs, which indicates both vertical and horizontal expansion of the scheme. One of the essential conditions for bringing micro and small sector under the ambit of formal lending, is creation of a unified database. Udyam Registration, started by the Ministry in July 2020, will prove crucial in this regard.

- **What is the progress on the front of the three-lakh crore credit guarantee package that was announced as part of the Atmanirbhar Bharat package for the MSME industry?**

As part of the Aatma Nirbhar Bharat Abhiyaan, Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) was launched on 23.5.2020 as an emergency measure to combat the unprecedented crisis caused in the wake of Covid-19 pandemic. The scheme is being administered by the Department of Financial Services, Ministry of Finance. The scheme has done exceptionally well. As on 24th September 2021, loans sanctioned have crossed Rs. 2.86 lakh crore under the Scheme and out of total guarantees issued, about 95% of the guarantees issued are for loans sanctioned to MSMEs. With a view to support various businesses impacted by the second wave of COVID-19 pandemic, it has been decided to extend the timeline of Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) till 31.03.2022 or till guarantees for an amount of Rs 4.5 lakh crore are issued under the scheme, whichever is earlier. Further, the last date of disbursement under the scheme has also been extended to 30.06.2022.

- **What are the steps taken by you to promote GDP growth and the creation of jobs for the youth through MSME segment?**

The Government of India has taken several measures and is working in close coordination with stakeholders to provide an enabling environment for promoting entrepreneurship, inclusive growth and sustainable development. The two broad objectives viz. creation of employment in the MSME sector and promotion of GDP growth supplement each other. Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP) is a major credit-linked subsidy programme aimed at generating self-employment opportunities through establishment of micro-enterprises in the non-farm sector by helping traditional artisans and unemployed youth. We will focus more on this scheme. Another area where we need to give special emphasis is the coir sector which has scope for creation of gainful employment. Our schemes for the coir sector have done well in the state of Kerala and Tamil Nadu. There is potential in other coastal states also and we would like to tap this opportunity. Our technology centres spread across the country also play a crucial role in this regard. They tend to resolve both demand and supply side issues of skilled manpower for the MSME sector. We are planning to have 20 new technology centres and 100 extension centres across the country to provide Technical Skill Development training to the youth at varying levels. A total of 34 Training Centres of Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) are also operational in the country to impart training in various fields related to Khadi and Village Industries. As per the Udyam registration portal, till date 52.7 lakh MSMEs are registered with total employment figure of 4,53,57,717.

- **MSMEs are reeling under pressure due to a lot of outstanding payment from public sector undertakings, even though maximum 45 days has been set as the limit under which they have to clear the dues. What steps have you taken to ensure regular clearing of payment to MSMEs by PSUs?**

The Ministry of MSME has launched SAMADHAAN portal for monitoring of the outstanding dues to the MSMEs from the buyers of goods and services. The portal gives information about individual CPSEs/Central Ministries, state governments etc. and other buyers regarding the payments pending with them in respect of the MSMEs. The said portal also facilitates MSMEs to file their delayed payments related complaints online.

A special sub-portal within SAMADHAAN portal for reporting the dues and monthly payments by Government of India Ministries and CPSEs to the MSMEs was launched on 14th June, 2020. Dues of Rs. 64,979.73 crore have been paid to the MSME vendors by Government Ministries/Dept/CPSUs from May 2020 till 12.10.2021. The Government

